

なんちょう まえ はな  
難聴：前から ゆっくり 話す

Hearing Loss — Face Him, Speak Slowly, Check He Understood — Scenario Dialogue

Can-do: Talk with a resident who cannot hear well: come round to the front before speaking, ask if he can hear, slow down instead of getting louder, use his better ear, check understanding with a question he must answer, and report a change in his hearing.

1 · Dialogue & Why — 会話

Hana  
(caregiver)

やまだ  
山田さん、おはようございます。

Good morning, Yamada-san.

**Why:** He does not turn round. That silence is your first information: he did not hear you, and he does not know you are in the room yet.

Yamada-san  
(resident)

え？ なん 何ですか。

Eh? What was that?

**Why:** He caught a sound, not the words. Do not repeat the same sentence from the same spot — change where you stand first.

Hana  
(caregiver)

かお み はな  
お顔を見て話しますね。

I'll talk to you face to face.

**Why:** THE RULE OF THIS EPISODE, first half. Come round to the front first. A resident with poor hearing reads your lips and face as much as he hears you — at his eye level, light on your face.

Hana  
(caregiver)

き  
聞こえますか。

Can you hear me?

**Why:** Ask it plainly, once. It tells him you have noticed, and it tells you where to start — it is care, not a test.

Yamada-san  
(resident)

き  
よく聞こえません。

I can't hear very well.

**Why:** 難聴 — hearing loss — is very common in older residents, and many are embarrassed by it. He told you honestly; answer in a way that makes it safe to keep telling you.

Hana  
(caregiver)

はな  
では、ゆっくり話しますね。

Then I'll speak slowly.

**Why:** THE RULE, second half. Slower and a little lower, not louder. Shouting breaks the sound apart and makes a kind sentence sound angry — and the whole corridor hears his business.

Hana  
(caregiver)

みぎ ひだり き  
右と 左、どちらが 聞こえますか。

Right or left — which ear hears better?

**Why:** Hearing is often better on one side. Ask once and remember it — then everyone on the shift can use his good side.

Yamada-san  
(resident)

みぎ みみ  
右の 耳が いいです。

My right ear is better.

**Why:** Now you know where to sit, where to stand at meals, and which side to speak from when you walk with him.

Hana  
(caregiver)

みぎ はな  
では、右から 話しますね。

Then I'll speak from your right side.

**Why:** Move to his good side and stay in front of him. Say what you are doing, so the move itself does not surprise him.

Hana  
(caregiver)

きょう ふろ  
今日は お風呂ですよ。

Today is your bath day.

**Why:** One short sentence, one idea. A long sentence gives him more words to lose — give the key word, then stop and let it land.

Yamada-san  
(resident)

ふろ  
お風呂ですか。

The bath?

**Why:** He repeats the key word back. That is a good sign — he caught it — so build on it with the next short piece.

Hana  
(caregiver)

じ い  
はい。10時に 行きましょう。

Yes. Let's go at ten.

**Why:** Numbers are the easiest thing to mishear. Say the time slowly, and hold up your fingers or point at the clock while you say it.

Hana  
(caregiver)

なんじ い  
何時に 行きますか。

So what time are we going?

**Why:** Check with a question he has to ANSWER. People who cannot hear well learn to nod to be polite, so a nod proves nothing — the time said back to you does.

Yamada-san  
(resident)

じ  
10時ですね。

At ten, right?

**Why:** Now you know he has it. If he had said a different time, you would say it again — slowly, from the front — never louder.

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Hana  
(caregiver)

そうです。大丈夫ですよ。  
だいじょうぶ

That's right. You've got it.

**Why:** Confirm it warmly. A resident who is corrected all day stops trying to hear; one who is told he got it keeps trying.

Hana  
(caregiver)

また聞いてくださいね。  
き

Just ask me again any time.

**Why:** Give him permission to ask. Many residents stay silent rather than ask twice — and silence is how a missed bath time or a missed pill happens.

Yamada-san  
(resident)

ありがとう。よく分かりました。  
わ

Thank you. I understood that well.

**Why:** Slower and from the front did what shouting never could. He heard every word — and he kept his dignity while you said them.

Hana  
(caregiver)

耳のことは、すぐ報告します。  
みみ ほうこく

I'll report about your hearing straight away.

**Why:** A change in hearing can be earwax, an ear infection or a flat hearing-aid battery — all fixable. Tell the nurse today, and which ear is his good one.

2・Key Vocabulary — 語彙

| # | 日本語                                               | ROMAJI         | ENGLISH                                                   | メモ / NOTES |
|---|---------------------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1 | <small>かお</small><br>顔                            | <i>kao</i>     | face                                                      |            |
| 2 | <small>はな</small><br>話す                           | <i>hanasu</i>  | to speak; talk                                            |            |
| 3 | <small>き</small><br>聞こえる                          | <i>kikoeru</i> | to be able to hear; be heard                              |            |
| 4 | ゆっくり                                              | <i>yukkuri</i> | slowly; without rushing<br>(recycled from Ep 23)          |            |
| 5 | <small>みぎ</small><br>右                            | <i>migi</i>    | right (side)                                              |            |
| 6 | <small>ひだり</small><br>左                           | <i>hidari</i>  | left (side)                                               |            |
| 7 | <small>みみ</small><br>耳                            | <i>mimi</i>    | ear                                                       |            |
| 8 | <small>ふろ</small><br>お風呂<br>仕事日本語・Shigoto Nihongo | <i>ofuro</i>   | bath<br>First video lessons on YouTube・ks-24-hearing-loss |            |

|    |                          |                    |                                       |  |
|----|--------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------|--|
| 9  | <sup>い</sup><br>行く       | <i>iku</i>         | to go                                 |  |
| 10 | <sup>なんじ</sup><br>何時     | <i>nanji</i>       | what time                             |  |
| 11 | <sup>だいじょうぶ</sup><br>大丈夫 | <i>daijoubu</i>    | okay; all right (recycled from Ep 23) |  |
| 12 | <sup>わ</sup><br>分かる      | <i>wakaru</i>      | to understand                         |  |
| 13 | <sup>ほうこく</sup><br>報告する  | <i>houkokusuru</i> | to report (recycled from Ep 23)       |  |

### 3・Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

| PATTERN                                           | MEANING & USE                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <sup>かお み はな</sup><br>お顔を 見て 話しますね                | Come round to the front — face to face          |
| <sup>き</sup><br>聞こえますか                            | Ask plainly whether he can hear you             |
| <sup>はな</sup><br>ゆっくり 話しますね                       | Slower and lower — never louder                 |
| <sup>なんじ い</sup><br>何時に 行きますか                     | Check with a question he must answer, not a nod |
| <sup>みみ</sup> 耳の ことは、すぐ <sup>ほうこく</sup> 報告<br>します | A change in hearing is reported the same day    |

### 4・Practice — れんしゅう

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

| # | SAY THIS IN JAPANESE                                                                                                                                                        | YOUR ANSWER |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| 1 | What does Yamada-san say about his ears? A) <sup>みぎ みみ</sup> 右の 耳が いいです B) <sup>ひだり みみ</sup> 左の 耳<br>が いいです C) よく <sup>き</sup> 聞こえます D) <sup>みみ</sup> 耳が <sup>いた</sup> 痛いです |             |
| 2 | What time is the bath? A) <sup>じ</sup> 8時 B) <sup>じ</sup> 9時 C) <sup>じ</sup> 10時 D) <sup>じ</sup> 12時                                                                        |             |
| 3 | Ask him whether he can hear you.                                                                                                                                            |             |
| 4 | Tell him you'll talk to him face to face.                                                                                                                                   |             |
| 5 | Tell him to just ask you again any time.                                                                                                                                    |             |

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### 5・Answer Key — こたえ

1. 右の<sup>みぎ</sup>耳<sup>みみ</sup>が いいです。

2. はい。10時<sup>じ</sup>に 行<sup>い</sup>きましょう。

3. 聞<sup>き</sup>こえますか。

4. お顔<sup>かお</sup>を 見<sup>み</sup>て 話<sup>はな</sup>しますね。

5. また 聞<sup>き</sup>いてくださいね。